

SCALING UP

A GAZELLES COMPANY



Your Scaling Up Report

Based on the Scaling Up Assessment

Leadership Team version

Scaling Up Assessment for: **John CEOExec**
May 1st 2026

PREFACE

Dear John,

Congratulations! You are now the owner of your own personalized ScaleUp Assessment report. With this report you will gain a better understanding of how well prepared you are for Scaling Up, how you and your company compare to your peers and what your priorities may be. To reach the 'next level' you now have the choice of using the Scaling Up book, implementing a growth program or working with a coach. Ultimately, this report will work as a guide and input towards your personal growth path. John CEOExec, you can use this report as a guide and as input for your personal growth path.

The assessment has been predominantly devised utilizing the Scaling Up / Rockefeller Habits 2.0 methodology, alongside academic growth models and organizational development theories. We have received input from many seasoned growth entrepreneurs, coaches, mentors and academics. We hope and believe you will be positively surprised by the number of Scaling Up insights throughout this report. We would highly recommend repeating this assessment annually, in order to keep track of your progress.

I wish you many great insights. Enjoy the report and keep scaling!

Verne

Verne Harnish



Verne Harnish, CEO
Scaling Up

Author of Scaling Up (Rockefeller Habits 2.0)
The Greatest Business Decisions of All Time
Mastering the Rockefeller Habits



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Scaling Up Coaching | Business Growth Framework & Certified Scaling Up Coaches Learn about the Scaling Up business growth methodology, the global community of certified Scaling Up Coaches, and how partnering with a Scaling Up Coach helps leadership teams accelerate growth, improve alignment, and achieve measurable results.





People



Strategy



Execution



Cash



You

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As the diagram suggests, all four areas (People, Strategy, Execution, Cash) are tied together and impact each other. You want to pay particular attention to the area that precedes your lowest score i.e. if your lowest score was Strategy the root cause could be People.



YOUR PROFILE

We begin with an overview on the main sections. The score is a weighted average of the questions per section. Your results are compared with your peer group.

	CEO score	Team avg	Peers	Dev from team	Dev from Peers
People	3.1	5.3	6.1	-2.2 ▼	-3.0 ▼
Your Employees	2.8	5.3	5.9	-2.5 ▼	-3.1 ▼
Company Culture	3.4	5.3	6.3	-1.9 ▼	-2.9 ▼
Strategy	2.0	7.1	5.0	-5.1 ▼	-3.0 ▼
Execution	1.6	6.2	5.8	-4.6 ▼	-4.2 ▼
Leadership Team	2.0	4.9	4.5	-2.9 ▼	-2.5 ▼
Operational Processes	1.4	5.5	5.6	-4.1 ▼	-4.2 ▼
Sales and Marketing	1.6	7.2	6.4	-5.6 ▼	-4.8 ▼
Scalability, Innovation and Technology	1.3	7.1	6.6	-5.8 ▼	-5.3 ▼
Cash	1.6	7.0	7.8	-5.4 ▼	-6.2 ▼
You	1.4	5.2	5.4	-1.2 ▼	-4.0 ▼
Internal Communication	1.2	5.2	4.6	-4.0 ▼	-3.4 ▼

Company culture and People rank highest. Internal communication and Scalability, technology and innovation rank lowest.

What are **Peers**? Peers are companies with a comparable size who have preceeded you in taking the Scaling Up Assessment. The database contains thousands of other growth companies.

In comparison to your peers, your scores for **Leadership team** and **Company culture** are relatively good. However, **Finance and cash** and **Scalability, technology and innovation** show a lower than average score.

PEOPLE

People - without a doubt the key to success within your organization. Every management book, academic study and personal story relays the same message. So, in your case John CEOExec, let's ask that key question: Are all your employees happy and engaged in the business? And would you 'rehire' all of them?

The success and scalability of your organization is mainly determined by the success that you have recruiting, training, involving, motivating and growing the best people you can find. And this can never be based on luck. Real success is based upon a philosophy around people, core values, the company culture, introduction program, continuous training and reward.

Note on reading the tables on the following pages

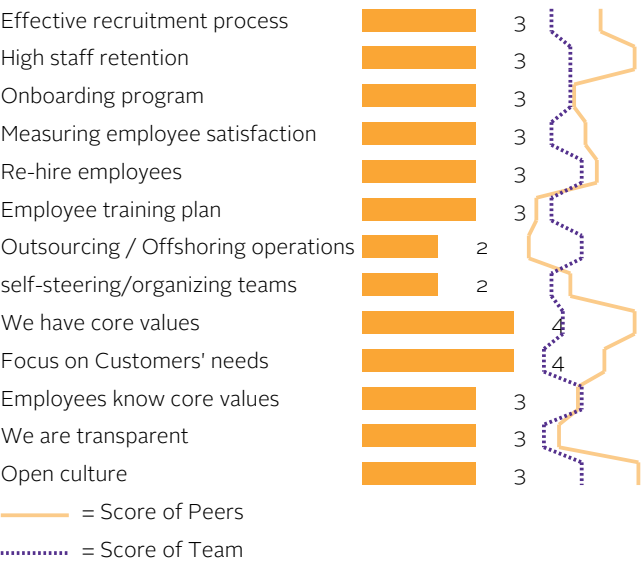
In the team score, the dark bar is the lowest score, the light bar is the highest score. The black stripe is the average score of the leadership team members. The number is the average score.

Example



People

Companies that nail this are usually the winners in their industry. Let's take a look at how you compare:



The biggest deviation from your team is in **Outsourcing / Offshoring operations, self-steering/organizing teams and Re-hire employees**



YOUR EMPLOYEES

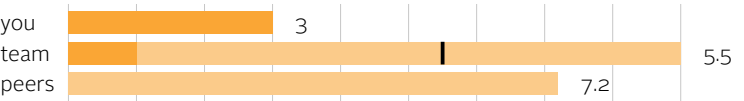
The average score for this section is 47.3. Your average score is 22. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

Effective recruitment process



In order to grow, you continuously need new - and good - people. This is often one of the most important challenges for a growth entrepreneur. You indicate that when it comes to finding new employees you find this very difficult. Ultimately, this is a matter of process, attention and time, often especially on the part of the entrepreneur. How much time do you spend on this? More than one day per week?

High staff retention



Your employee turnover is high. Unwanted turnover is often a sign that processes, strategy or management are not in order. It takes an enormous amount of money and effort to continually find and train new employees. Find out what the reasons are, hold exit interviews and ask yourself whether you yourself would want to work at your company.

Onboarding program



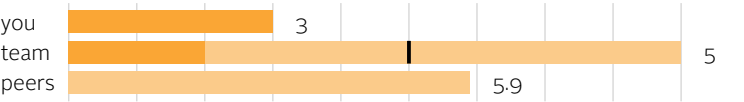
Employees do not receive a comprehensive onboarding program at your company. While this is understandable for a company of your size, a well-thought-out onboarding program will be an enormous help to employees with regard to learning their job, becoming



People

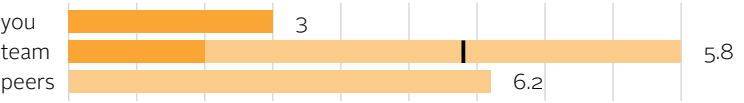
familiar with the company's core values and getting to know their coworkers. It will help enormously with scaling up your company. It might be good to start thinking about this already.

Measuring employee satisfaction



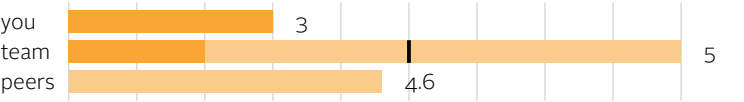
You do not yet measure employee satisfaction. That's understandable with a company of your size. You usually know quite well what's going on. This is something for the next phase.

Positive about re-hiring employees



You would hire few or none of your current employees again. Ouch. This means that you have either postponed a lot of difficult decisions or you simply have a very bad hiring policy. You should work on this, because without good employees you can't grow.

Every employee has a training plan



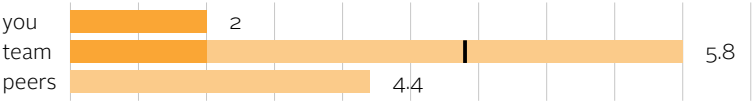
Management thinker Tom Peters stated in his latest book 'one of the greatest responsibilities of an employer nowadays is the continuous development of employees'. In fast growing companies, roles are continuously changing, the need for training and education is therefore imperative. In your phase it is logical that this is not up to par, but you might want to start thinking about it.





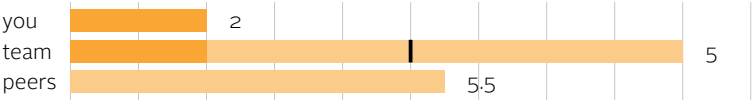
People

Outsourcing / Offshoring operations



You are not active with offshoring or outsourcing, this strategy is completely depending on your product/service, cost and scaling strategy.

We apply flat-management or self-steering/organizing teams



You have not implemented new management models, when things work for you, don't change.



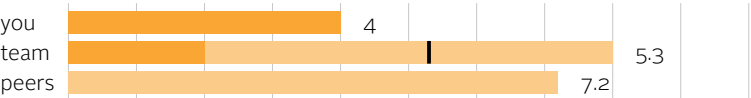


People

COMPANY CULTURE

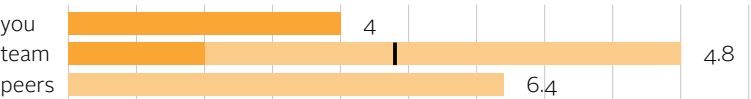
The average score for this section is 31.4. Your average score is 17. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

We have Core values



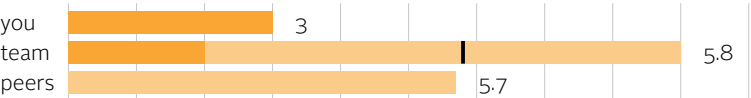
Core values are the internal 'rules of the game'. It's essential to have this very clear if you start growing quickly, but in small organizations it's often not yet necessary to make this explicit.

We have focus on customers' needs



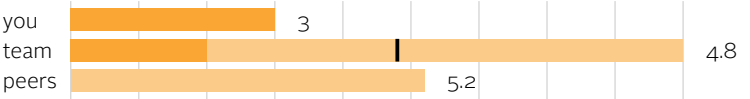
Growth often creates increased management attention to internal matters, employees, new premises, computer systems, etc. The most rapidly growing and successful companies keep a sharp focus on the continuously (changing) needs of the customer. Making and keeping this focus and attention explicit is important, especially in this phase of your company.

Employees know core values



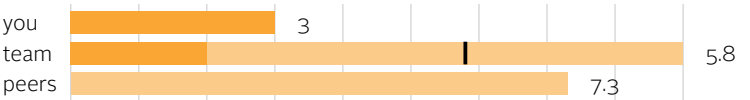
You have not formulated any core values. That's less important in your phase. Because of the small team, everyone subconsciously knows what's important. However, if you grow and hire new employees, it will be increasingly important to make this explicitly clear.

We are transparent



Transparency of information (about customers, sales, goals, growth, etc.) produces greater employee involvement. In addition, it often prevents internal "politics". It would be beneficial for you to start considering what information you are willing to share.

We have a positive and healthy culture



"Culture eats Strategy for breakfast" is a famous quote from management guru Peter Drucker. The outside world is changing rapidly, but a positive and healthy culture in which employees take responsibility, think along and always act in the interest of the company is therefore an enormous "asset". You still have a small company, but it would be good to start working on such a culture already now.





Strategy

STRATEGY

Articulating a clear and differential strategy, supported by a strong core culture that can deliver on the brand's promises, is the key for any company that wants to scale up. So how do you know if you have this industry dominating strategy? Sustainable top-line revenue growth and an increasing gross margin are the two key financial indicators. If you don't have a killer strategy your company will slowly face continuous pricing pressures as the market commoditizes your products and services.

John CEOExec, to have such a strong and effective strategy, it is key that the leadership team has a system and process to devote time and attention to this. A strong strategy needs a very clear and compelling vision and long term goal (BHAG). It needs to be specific and clear on which clients you want to service, how you will be unique and that your competences are clearly aligned with that goal. You then need clear measureable (non financial) yearly and quarterly goals. And a process needs to be in place to review and discuss trends and information from employees, clients and the market in general. Information on competition, technologies and potential disrupters needs to be part of the periodic strategic assessment.

And a strategy works best when all employees know it, understand it and are motivated by it.

Let's look at your results.



The biggest deviation from your team is in **Acquisitions strategy, Strategic plan and Employee personalized goals**



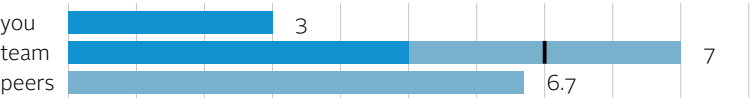


Strategy

GOALS AND STRATEGY

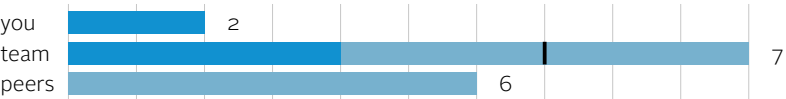
The average score for this section is 34.9. Your average score is 14. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

We have formulated a long term (non-financial) goal



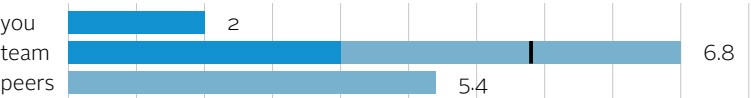
You have not yet formulated a clear long-term goal. That's too bad, because a long-term goal provides direction and context and above all motivation for all employees. Companies that do this effectively are at an enormous advantage.

We have formulated yearly goals



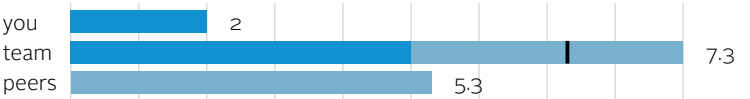
The clearer and more measurably you formulate your goals (both financially and organizationally or with regard to product or market development), the higher the chance that you will also achieve those goals. This will have a clarifying and motivating effect and ensure growth. It's time to get started!

We have formulated quarterly/ monthly goals (other than financial goals)



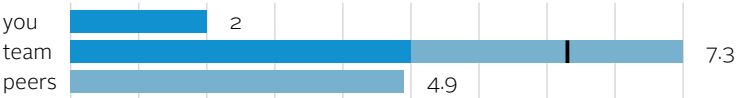
You have no monthly or quarterly goals. Ouch. Monthly or quarterly goals give you guidance and direction and ensure that you will achieve your annual goals. Think of them as "small sprints" that you have to win in order to achieve your annual goal. Fast growers are very disciplined in this process.

We work with a strategic plan



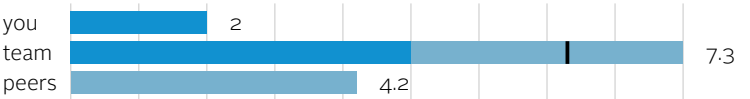
You do not yet have a business plan. Maybe this isn't necessary yet in your phase. But establishing your goals, strategy and action plan can bring about a lot of clarity and teach you to anticipate certain challenges. When should you hire someone? What will the marketing strategy be? You have to make many difficult choices; a complete overview and plan will help you with this.

Each employee has personalized goals



You haven't started working on personal goals yet. Team goals and personal goals are the next step in working efficiently. This creates clarity, commitment, personal responsibility and motivation. Think about how this would work at your company.

We have implemented a growth methodology

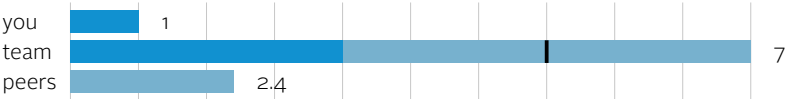


You have not yet implemented a growth methodology. That is logical in the phase that your company is in. However, it's never too early to start thinking about that.



Strategy

We have an active acquisitions strategy



You are not active with acquisitions, that seems logical for the company your size.



Execution

EXECUTION

Execution is, in many organizations, the biggest challenge. Where most entrepreneurs have a natural passion for clients, product development and innovation, many of them lack the skills and intrinsic motivation for a flawless and scalable execution. Execution and operations are broad areas and its success is dependent from many factors. But let us first distinguish leadership and management. As the entrepreneur of the organization, the focus lies on leadership, with the key objective being emotional involvement in the long and short term vision of the company across all employees. Management however is focused on process. The right people doing the right things right. And do all processes run without drama and drive industry-leading profitability? The entrepreneur does not have to be the person to manage this. An operations director, COO, or well functioning management team are, in many situations, the critical people to get this right.

Execution success is dependent on many factors. A well functioning leadership team, with a disciplined process and rhythm for prioritization and goalsetting. Clear KPIs, measurement systems, a process for employee and client feedback. Automation and digitalization of primary and secondary processes and so on.

We have put the sales and marketing function also in this chapter, as we see the systematic organization of these processes as part of the execution.

OK, let's see how you scored:



The biggest deviation from your team is in **Head of sales not entrepreneur, PR/communication strategy and Systems prepped for growth**

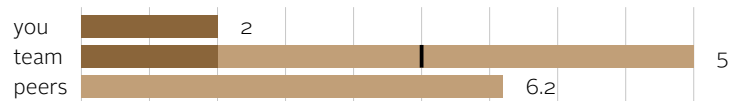


Execution

LEADERSHIP TEAM

The average score for this section is 18.1. Your average score is 8. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

Tasks are properly allocated



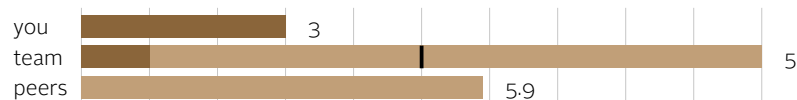
You do not yet have an efficient leadership team. That's not unusual in your phase. However, for the next growth step you should start thinking about the form and composition of the management. This will help you create more involvement and make the company less dependent on you.

We have weekly management meetings.



You have not yet implemented a weekly leadership meeting. In order to create structure, it's good to implement a regular management meeting and systematically determine decisions and actions.

We have periodic strategic sessions.



You do not yet have strategic sessions. It is important - including in your phase - to involve employees in your long-term planning. That's why you should start planning strategic sessions with all - or your most important - employees.

Leadership team receives regular training



When your organization is growing rapidly and therefore constantly changing, it is important - even at smaller organizations - for everyone to continue learning. We advise you to start doing this.

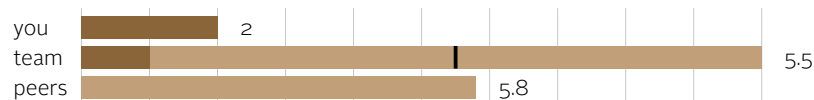


Execution

OPERATIONAL PROCESSES

The average score for this section is 27.9. Your average score is 7. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

Our goals are translated into clear KPIs



Making goals measurable is an important step towards creating personal accountability and professionalizing processes. This includes numbers of leads, received applications, IT development, etc. With a company of your size this is usually still a step too early, but it is perhaps something to think about if you start to grow.

We use real-time data to measure our performance



Because of the size of your company, perhaps you know exactly "what's going on". However, if you start to grow you will have to have up-to-date information available, both for yourself as well as for your employees. It's time to think about this.

We grow with limited mistakes, errors and problems



Work pressure and lack of process often lead to coordination problems and mistakes. That's a shame and could potentially damage your reputation among customers. It's time to take stock of the processes and make clear arrangements. If you don't like doing this yourself, ask an employee to make this number one priority. If you don't resolve this, it will only get worse.

We measure customer satisfaction



You do not yet measure customer satisfaction. That's too bad, because this provides important input for the further development of your products and processes. In any case, you should try having regular contact with customers to find out what you can improve.

We have systematic processes for continuous improvement



A system to prevent mistakes and take stock of complaints/feedback is usually not really necessary yet for a company of your size. However, when you start to grow and hire new people, it's often good to structure work processes and set up a system of quality checks and customer feedback. Preventing mistakes is usually significantly cheaper than continually fixing them.



Execution

SALES AND MARKETING

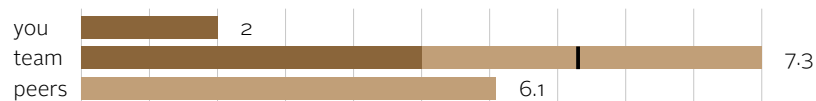
The average score for this section is 31.9. Your average score is 8. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

We have an effective lead generation process



To grow you need new customers. Often sales are very dependent on the entrepreneur with a company of your size. Then it's wise to start thinking about a lead generation system and process.

Sales achievement



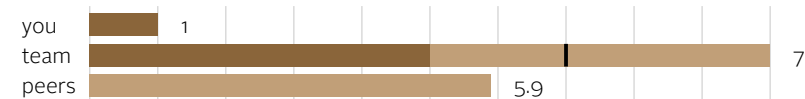
Having and achieving targets is, of course, the basis for business success and growth. At successful companies this correlation is no coincidence. The sales process will often consist of a combination of targets, bonus schemes, lead generation as well as weekly meetings, coaching, training, motivational sessions, etc. It might be good to start thinking about this already.

Weekly sales meeting



Stimulating sales is hardly possible without a disciplined process. A weekly sales meeting in which successes as well as setbacks and lessons learned are shared is an important part of the success of fast-growing companies. Often there are also one-on-one meetings with individual sales reps - if applicable. It's time to start with this.

Head of sales is not the entrepreneur



With a company of your size, the entrepreneur is often in charge when it comes to sales. With the increasing pressure on general management tasks, it's good to ensure that you as an entrepreneur free up sufficient time for this. If this is not the case, you will have to start making choices.

We have an effective PR/communication strategy



Nowadays sales and marketing strategies are usually accompanied with an effective content-based communication strategy. This is something you might want to think about.



Execution

SCALABILITY, TECHNOLOGY AND INNOVATION

The average score for this section is 39.6. Your average score is 8. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

Most processes are automated



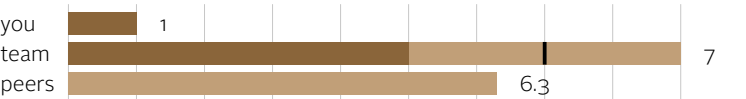
In order to scale, smart application and linking of information technology is essential. Sales, marketing, project management, production, human resources, reporting, etc. This gives structure and clarity, prevents mistakes and makes growing a lot easier. With the size of your company, a lot of systems likely still work independently of each other, or you primarily use Excel. This is customary, but in your next growth phase you will have to start thinking about smart solutions.

Systems prepped for growth



Your systems are not yet prepared for growth. When you grow, a lot changes at the same time: systems, structures, people, processes, etc. It helps a lot when your systems can handle this growth. Otherwise it's sort of like changing the tires while driving!

Better systems than competitors



Many fast growers have invested in information technology systems that help them be better, smarter, more efficient and more market-oriented than their competitors. You don't have any systems that are

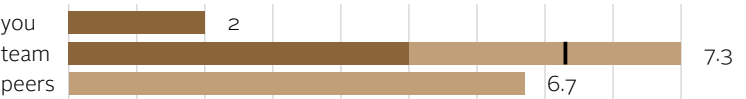
better than most of your competitors. Where might IT be able to help you?

Knowledge on latest technology



As an entrepreneur, you always have 1001 focus areas. You must keep an eye on technological developments that could enormously affect your business model or company efficiency. You should devote time to this on a regular basis.

We are more innovative than competitors



In this world, where developments are super fast, you can quickly be made less relevant by a competitor if you don't pay attention (for example, by focusing too much on internal issues). It is wise to continuously make improvement and innovation part of the organization's DNA.

Our business model is disruptive



You do not have a disruptive business model. Keep your eyes open for newcomers in your market. Or you might want to think creating a disruptive model yourself.



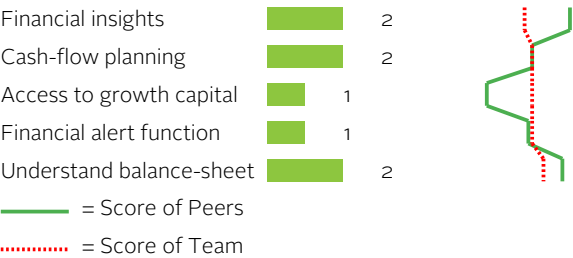
Cash

FINANCE AND CASH

Growth sucks cash. This is the first law of entrepreneurial gravity. Yet many company leaders pay more attention to revenue and profit than they do to cash. And usually a company needs to be in severe cash crisis before predictive systems are implemented and the business model is optimized to be cash rich.

So the key question is: Do you have consistent cash sources, ideally internally generated, to fuel business growth?

Let's see how your are doing compared to your peers:



The biggest deviation from your team is in **Access to growth capital, Financial alert function and Understand balance-sheet**

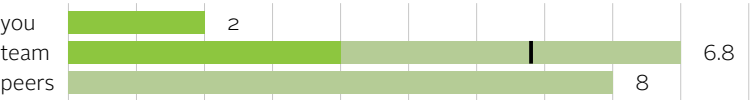


Cash

FINANCE AND CASH

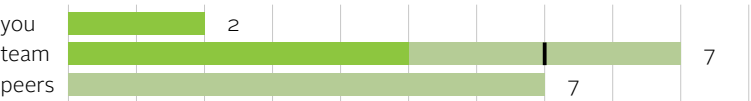
The average score for this section is 39. Your average score is 8. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

Real time financial insights



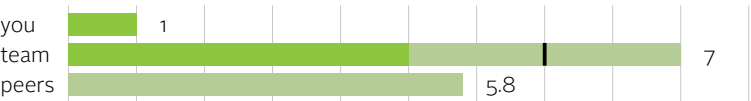
You have no up-to-date knowledge of sales and costs. For a growth company, this is the same as driving 90 mph with a blindfold on. Maybe this should be your first priority to tackle tomorrow.

Up-to-date cashflow planning



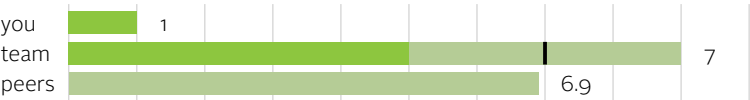
You don't employ cash flow planning. As a small business, you always have to look ahead a few months with regard to your cash flow, as otherwise you'll inevitably end up in trouble, especially if you grow.

Access to growth capital



You have no access to growth capital. This isn't a problem, unless you want to grow a lot. After all, growth gobbles up cash. You could create a list of the various alternatives (friends/fools/family, the bank, factoring, SME bonds, crowd funding, angel investors, private equity, Government Funding, etc.). There are a lot of service providers who can help you with this.

Financial alert function



It is crucial to have "early warning systems" with regard to financial parameters. The faster you can intervene or take measures, the better. You indicate that this is not the case at your company. That's dangerous. What are you going to do about it?

Leadership understands balance sheet



Reading and understanding a balance sheet appears to be a tricky thing for many entrepreneurs. While a balance sheet is a smart blueprint that can expose the dynamics and growth potential behind your company. With a company of your size this is not a priority, but if you grow you should spend a good amount of time and attention on this.



You

YOU

Peter Drucker nailed it: "The Bottleneck is always on top of the bottle". We mentioned that people are the most critical factor in defining a company's success. We lied. It is, in fact, you, the entrepreneur, founder and leader. Therefore, the responsibility lies with this person in recruitment, motivation, training and overall involvement ensuring the business reaches a higher level.

In other words, your ambition level, energy, speeches, involvement and example behavior are the real key to scaling up. Interestingly, your behavior needs to adapt to cater for each new organizational phase. This requires growth and development from you, as the leader too. Continuously identifying what the organization needs from you. This starts with moving from working 'in' your company to working 'at' your company and usually ends with making sure that you let your professional management run the operations so you can build the organization even further.

Within this process one of the key areas of success is the level in which you involve your employees in the company vision and goals. Hence why we stress the importance of internal communication.

To continuously grow as a leader is challenging. Having a mentor or coach can be extremely beneficial in setting you on the right leadership development trajectory. Successful leaders are happy, have a good work-life balance, read a lot and learn from other entrepreneurs. Note, it is about the decisions you take, not the time that you put in.

John CEOExec, let's look at your results. We see that you have 20 years experience as an entrepreneur and that you have 2 partner(s) in your business.



The biggest deviation from your team is in **Employees know yearly goals, Employees know long term goal and Employees know elevator pitch**



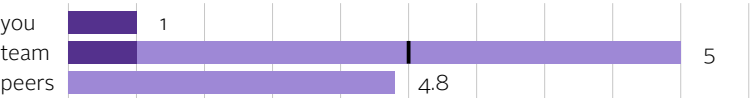


You

INTERNAL COMMUNICATION

The average score for this section is 27.5. Your average score is 7. Therefore, on average you are doing under your peer group.

Employees know long term goal



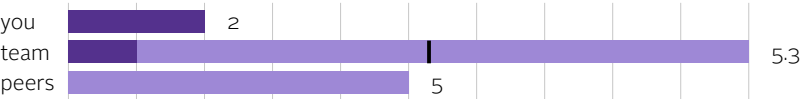
A long-term goal for the organization gives everyone a clear framework for strategy and decisions - and can be very motivating. With a company of your size it isn't really necessary to establish all of this clearly yet, but it will help. But you can start thinking about it.

Employees know yearly goal



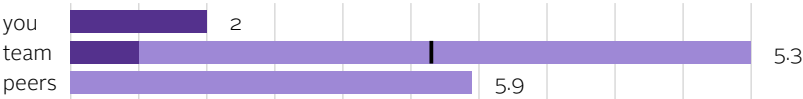
Focusing on goals, including annual goals, provides direction and a framework to your business activities. In addition, this information motivates your employees. In this phase you should start thinking about making all of this a bit clearer.

Employees know quarterly/monthly goals



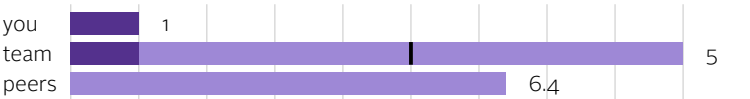
Focusing on goals, including monthly goals and KPIs, provides guidance and direction to business activities. Actually, you make a small sprint every month to ensure that you are "on schedule". The clearer the goal the clearer it becomes on how to achieve it. Perhaps you can think about how this would work at your company.

Employees know vision and mission



As with the long-term goal - it is important for the company's vision and mission to be clear. This motivates employees and provides a clear framework for the activities. In your phase this doesn't all need to be in place yet, but you can start thinking about what that vision and mission might look like.

Employees know elevator pitch



You'd be surprised to hear the stories and answers you get to the question "What exactly does your company do?". It is a good idea to formulate a common language and text - and to practice together. Everything will become clearer. Both internally as well as externally.

We frequently have company-wide meetings



Research shows that it's crucial to communicate goals and performance to all employees, providing them with context regarding development. Face-to-face, with internal sessions works best. With internal sessions, in other words. With a company of your size this may seem too much "overkill" in information and process, but perhaps it would be good to start on it already.

IN CONCLUSION

This was your report of the Scaling Up Assessment. You have a ScaleUp Score of **19**. You have still a lot of focus areas on which you can work within your company. If you want to grow quickly, then your organization is probably not ready yet. You scored highest on **Company culture** and lowest on **Internal communication**. In comparison to other companies, in the same phase, you score higher on **Leadership team** and lower on **Finance and cash**. Your biggest challenge - as you describe it - is "**fdgsdf sfdg sfdsgdfg sgs sgsgdfg**". Hopefully this report has given you sufficient insight into where you and your organization can improve. Good luck and we'll see you back at this Scaling Up Assessment - perhaps for a higher score...

We would like to thank you for undergoing this Scaling Up Assessment. If you would like any support in implementing the Scaling Up/ Rockefeller Habits methodology, please get in touch via www.scalingup.com and we will connect you to a certified coach or partner. Over the past 30 years we've offered support to around 80,000 organizations, Scaling Up through coaching, workshops, dashboard tools and online training.

Keep Scaling,

Verne Harnish



People



Strategy



Execution



Cash



You

Appendix A

People



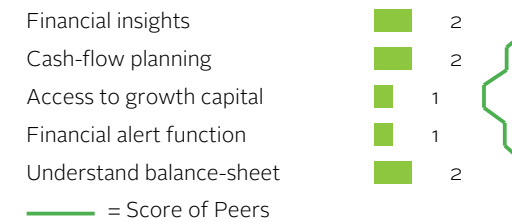
Strategy



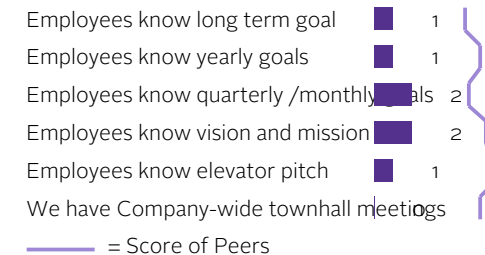
Execution



Cash



You





People



Strategy



Execution



Cash



You

Appendix B

	People	Strategy	Execution	Cash
CEO score	3.1	2.0	1.6	1.6
Person 1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.0
Person 2	9.0	9.1	9.5	9.2
Person 3	1.9	9.1	5.1	9.0
Person 4	5.3	5.0	5.1	4.8

